

Sets

• Exercise 1

Suppose $A, B, D \subseteq X$. Prove the following properties

$$1. (A \setminus B)^c = A^c \cup B.$$

Proof

$$\begin{aligned} x \in (A \setminus B)^c &\Leftrightarrow x \notin (A \setminus B) \Leftrightarrow \text{It is false that } x \in A \setminus B \\ &\Leftrightarrow \text{It is false that } x \in A \wedge x \notin B \\ &\Leftrightarrow \text{It is true that } \neg(x \in A \wedge x \notin B) \\ &\Leftrightarrow x \notin A \vee x \in B \Leftrightarrow x \notin A \text{ or } x \in B \\ &\Leftrightarrow x \in A^c \cup B. \end{aligned}$$

$$\text{Thus } (A \setminus B)^c = A^c \cup B.$$

$$2. A \cap (B \setminus D) = (A \cap B) \setminus (A \cap D).$$

Proof

$$\begin{aligned} x \in A \cap (B \setminus D) &\Leftrightarrow x \in A \wedge x \in B \setminus D \\ &\Leftrightarrow x \in A \wedge x \in B \wedge x \notin D \\ &\Leftrightarrow (x \in A \wedge x \in B) \wedge (x \in A \wedge x \notin D) \\ &\Leftrightarrow x \in A \cap B \wedge x \notin A \cap D \\ &\Leftrightarrow x \in (A \cap B) \setminus (A \cap D). \end{aligned}$$

$$\text{Thus } A \cap (B \setminus D) = (A \cap B) \setminus (A \cap D).$$

• Exercise 2

Let A and B be two sets. Prove that $\mathcal{P}(A) \cup \mathcal{P}(B) \subseteq \mathcal{P}(A \cup B)$.

◦ Proof 2.1

Suppose

$$\begin{aligned} X \in \mathcal{P}(A) \cup \mathcal{P}(B) &\Rightarrow X \in \mathcal{P}(A) \text{ or } X \in \mathcal{P}(B) \\ &\Leftrightarrow X \subseteq A \text{ or } X \subseteq B \\ &\Rightarrow X \subseteq A \subseteq A \cup B \text{ or } X \subseteq B \subseteq A \cup B \\ &\Rightarrow \text{In any case, } X \subseteq A \cup B \\ &\Rightarrow X \in \mathcal{P}(A \cup B). \end{aligned}$$

$$\text{Thus } \mathcal{P}(A) \cup \mathcal{P}(B) \subseteq \mathcal{P}(A \cup B).$$

• Exercise 3

Suppose $A_n = \left[-\frac{1}{n}, 1 + \frac{1}{n}\right]$ for $n \in \mathbb{N}$, find $\bigcup_{n \in \mathbb{N}} A_n$, $\bigcap_{n \in \mathbb{N}} A_n$, $\bigcup_{n \in \mathbb{N}} A_n^c$ and $\bigcap_{n \in \mathbb{N}} A_n^c$.

◦ Solution 3.1

Let's prove $\forall n \in \mathbb{N}, A_n \supseteq A_{n+1} \Leftrightarrow \left[-\frac{1}{n}, 1 + \frac{1}{n}\right] \supseteq \left[-\frac{1}{n+1}, 1 + \frac{1}{n+1}\right]$.
Suppose $n \in \mathbb{N}$, $-\frac{1}{n+1} \leq x \leq 1 + \frac{1}{n+1}$, we want to prove $-\frac{1}{n} \leq x \leq 1 + \frac{1}{n}$.

$$-\frac{1}{n} \leq \frac{1}{n+1} \leq x \leq 1 + \frac{1}{n+1} \leq 1 + \frac{1}{n}.$$

Thus $-\frac{1}{n} \leq x \leq 1 + \frac{1}{n}$, then $\forall n \in \mathbb{N}, A_n \supseteq A_{n+1}$.

As n increases, the intervals A_n become nested, meaning $A_1 \supseteq A_2 \supseteq A_3 \supseteq \dots$

For $n = 1$, we have $A_1 = [-1, 2]$. We have $A_1 = \bigcup_{n \in \mathbb{N}} A_n$ because

$$A_1 \subseteq \bigcup_{n \in \mathbb{N}} A_n = A_1 \bigcup_{\substack{n \in \mathbb{N} \\ n \geq 2}} A_n$$

and

$$\bigcup_{n \in \mathbb{N}} A_n \subseteq A_1.$$

The **union** is equal to the largest interval

$$\bigcup_{n \in \mathbb{N}} A_n = [-1, 2].$$

Lets prove $\bigcap_n A_n = [0, 1]$. We have

$$[0, 1] \subseteq \bigcap_n A_n \iff \forall n \in \mathbb{N}, [0, 1] \subseteq A_n = \left[-\frac{1}{n}, 1 + \frac{1}{n}\right]$$

and suppose $y < 0$. Consider $\epsilon := -y > 0$ By the Archimedean Property

$$\exists N \in \mathbb{N} \text{ such that } \frac{1}{N} < \epsilon = -y \implies y < -\frac{1}{N}.$$

Thus $y \notin \left[-\frac{1}{N}, 1 + \frac{1}{N}\right]$. Then $y \notin \bigcap_n A_n$. So $0 \in \bigcap_n A_n$.

Similarly, $1 \in \bigcap_n A_n$.

The **intersection** approaches the limit points 0 and 1 from the outside, including them

$$\bigcap_{n \in \mathbb{N}} A_n = [0, 1].$$

By **De Morgan's laws**, the union of the complements is the complement of the intersection

$$\bigcup_{n \in \mathbb{N}} A_n^c = \left(\bigcap_{n \in \mathbb{N}} A_n \right)^c = (-\infty, 0) \cup (1, \infty)$$

Similarly, the intersection of the complements is the complement of the union

$$\bigcap_{n \in \mathbb{N}} A_n^c = \left(\bigcup_{n \in \mathbb{N}} A_n \right)^c = (-\infty, -1) \cup (2, \infty)$$

• Exercise 4

Let $M = \{4, \{5\}, \{4, 5\}\}$. Determine which of the following assertions are correct.

- (a) $5 \in M$
- (c) $\{5\} \subseteq M$
- (b) $(A \setminus B)^c = A^c \cup B$
- (f) $A \subseteq B \iff A \cap B = A$
- (g) $A \cup (A \cap B) = A$
- (j) $A \cap (B \setminus D) = (A \cap B) \setminus (A \cap D)$
- (e) $\{4, 5\} \in M$
- (g) $\{\{4, 5\}\} \in M$
- (i) $\emptyset \in M$
- (k) $M \in M$

◦ Solution 4.1

- **(a) Incorrect.** The number 5 is not a direct element of M ; the set $\{5\}$ is.
- **(c) Incorrect.** For $\{5\} \subseteq M$ to be true, $5 \in M$ must hold, which is false.
- **(b) Correct.** By definition,

$$\begin{aligned} x \in (A \setminus B)^c &\iff x \notin A \setminus B \\ &\iff \neg(x \in A \wedge x \notin B) \\ &\iff x \notin A \vee x \in B \\ &\iff x \in A^c \vee x \in B \\ &\iff x \in A^c \cup B \end{aligned}$$

- **(f) Correct.**

($\implies$) If $A \subseteq B$, then for any $x \in A$, $x \in B$ must hold. Thus $x \in A \implies x \in A \wedge x \in B \implies x \in A \cap B$, showing $A \subseteq A \cap B$. Since $A \cap B \subseteq A$ always holds by definition, $A \cap B = A$.

($\impliedby$) If $A \cap B = A$, then for any $x \in A$, we have $x \in A \cap B$, which means $x \in B$ by definition of intersection. Thus $A \subseteq B$.

- **(g) Correct.** By definition, $x \in A \cup (A \cap B) \iff x \in A \vee (x \in A \wedge x \in B) \iff x \in A$.
- **(j) Correct.** By definition:

$$x \in A \cap (B \setminus D) \iff x \in A \wedge (x \in B \wedge x \notin D) \iff (x \in A \wedge x \in B) \wedge x \notin D$$

On the other side:

$$x \in (A \cap B) \setminus (A \cap D) \iff (x \in A \wedge x \in B) \wedge \neg(x \in A \wedge x \in D) \iff (x \in A \wedge x \in B) \wedge (x \notin A \vee x \notin D)$$

Since $x \in A$ is already true from the first part, $x \notin A$ is false, so $(x \notin A \vee x \notin D)$ simplifies directly to $x \notin D$. Thus, both sides mean $(x \in A \wedge x \in B) \wedge x \notin D$.

- **(e) Correct.** The set $\{4, 5\}$ is explicitly listed as the third element of M .
- **(g) Incorrect.** The nested set $\{\{4, 5\}\}$ is not an element belonging to M .
- **(i) Incorrect.** The empty set $\emptyset$ is not explicitly listed inside M .
- **(k) Incorrect.** By the Axiom of Regularity, no set can contain itself as an element.

• **Exercise 5**

Suppose $A, B, D \subseteq U$. Prove the following properties.

- (a) $A \cap (A \cup B) = A$
- (c) $A \setminus (B \cup D) = (A \setminus B) \cap (A \setminus D)$
- (d) $(A \cap B)^c = A^c \cup B^c$
- (e) $A \subseteq B \iff A \cup B = B$
- (h) $(A \cup B)^c = A^c \cap B^c$
- (i) $(A \setminus B) \cup (A \cap B) = A$

◦ **Solution 5.1**

■ **(a) Proof:**

We prove this by showing $x \in A \cap (A \cup B) \iff x \in A$:

$$x \in A \cap (A \cup B) \iff x \in A \wedge (x \in A \vee x \in B) \iff x \in A$$

■ **(c) Proof:**

We use the element-hood definition to show logical equivalence:

$$\begin{aligned} x \in A \setminus (B \cup D) &\iff x \in A \wedge x \notin (B \cup D) \\ &\iff x \in A \wedge \neg(x \in B \vee x \in D) \\ &\iff x \in A \wedge (x \notin B \wedge x \notin D) \\ &\iff (x \in A \wedge x \notin B) \wedge (x \in A \wedge x \notin D) \\ &\iff x \in (A \setminus B) \wedge x \in (A \setminus D) \\ &\iff x \in (A \setminus B) \cap (A \setminus D) \end{aligned}$$

■ **(d) Proof:**

By definition of the complement and logical negation:

$$\begin{aligned} x \in (A \cap B)^c &\iff x \notin A \cap B \\ &\iff \neg(x \in A \wedge x \in B) \\ &\iff x \notin A \vee x \notin B \\ &\iff x \in A^c \vee x \in B^c \\ &\iff x \in A^c \cup B^c \end{aligned}$$

■ **(e) Proof:**

($\implies$) Assume $A \subseteq B$, meaning if $x \in A$ then $x \in B$. We show $A \cup B = B$:

- If $x \in A \cup B$, then $x \in A$ or $x \in B$. If $x \in A$, then $x \in B$ by assumption. Thus $x \in B$ in both cases, which means $A \cup B \subseteq B$.
- If $x \in B$, then $x \in A \vee x \in B$ is automatically true, so $x \in A \cup B$, meaning $B \subseteq A \cup B$. Thus, $A \cup B = B$.

($\impliedby$) Assume $A \cup B = B$. Let $x \in A$. Then $x \in A \vee x \in B$ is true, so $x \in A \cup B$. Since $A \cup B = B$, it follows that $x \in B$. Hence, $A \subseteq B$.

■ **(h) Proof:**

By definition of the complement and logical negation:

$$\begin{aligned} x \in (A \cup B)^c &\iff x \notin A \cup B \\ &\iff \neg(x \in A \vee x \in B) \\ &\iff x \notin A \wedge x \notin B \\ &\iff x \in A^c \wedge x \in B^c \\ &\iff x \in A^c \cap B^c \end{aligned}$$

■ **(i) Proof:**

We use the element-hood definition to show logical equivalence:

$$\begin{aligned}
x \in (A \setminus B) \cup (A \cap B) &\iff x \in (A \setminus B) \vee x \in (A \cap B) \\
&\iff (x \in A \wedge x \notin B) \vee (x \in A \wedge x \in B) \\
&\iff x \in A \wedge (x \notin B \vee x \in B) \\
&\iff x \in A \wedge \text{True} \\
&\iff x \in A
\end{aligned}$$

• **Exercise 6**

Let A, B, C be subsets of a universal set X . Prove the implication: If $A \cap B \subseteq C$ and $C \subseteq A \cup B$, then $C \setminus A \subseteq B$.

◦ **Solution 6.1**

Proof:

Let $x \in C \setminus A$. By definition of set difference, this means:

$$x \in C \quad \text{and} \quad x \notin A$$

We are given the condition $C \subseteq A \cup B$. Since $x \in C$, it must follow by definition of subset that:

$$x \in A \cup B$$

By definition of union, this means $x \in A$ or $x \in B$.

However, we already established from the definition of $C \setminus A$ that $x \notin A$.

Therefore, for the disjunction $(x \in A \vee x \in B)$ to hold true while $x \in A$ is false, $x \in B$ must be true.

Since any arbitrary element $x \in C \setminus A$ satisfies $x \in B$, we conclude by definition of subset that:

$$C \setminus A \subseteq B$$

The proof is complete.

• **Exercise 7**

Let A, B be arbitrary sets. Prove or disprove: $\mathcal{P}(A \setminus B) = \mathcal{P}(A) \setminus \mathcal{P}(B)$. If false, provide an explicit counterexample.

◦ **Solution 7.1**

The statement is **false**.

Counterexample:

Let $A = \{1\}$ and $B = \{2\}$.

Then, the set difference is $A \setminus B = \{1\}$.

The power sets of these collections are:

$$\mathcal{P}(A \setminus B) = \{\emptyset, \{1\}\}$$

$$\mathcal{P}(A) = \{\emptyset, \{1\}\}, \quad \mathcal{P}(B) = \{\emptyset, \{2\}\}$$

Evaluating the right side of the proposed equation yields:

$$\mathcal{P}(A) \setminus \mathcal{P}(B) = \{\{1\}\}$$

Since $\{\emptyset, \{1\}\} \neq \{\{1\}\}$, the statement does not hold in general.

• **Exercise 8**

Let $A, B \subseteq X$. Prove that $A \subseteq B$ if and only if for every set C , $A \cap C \subseteq B \cap C$.

◦ **Solution 8.1**

Proof:

($\implies$) Assume $A \subseteq B$. Let C be any arbitrary set, and let $x \in A \cap C$. By definition of intersection, this means:

$$x \in A \quad \text{and} \quad x \in C$$

Since $A \subseteq B$, by definition of subset, $x \in A \implies x \in B$. Therefore, we have:

$$x \in B \quad \text{and} \quad x \in C$$

By definition of intersection, $x \in B \cap C$. Since any arbitrary element $x \in A \cap C$ satisfies $x \in B \cap C$, we conclude that $A \cap C \subseteq B \cap C$.

($\impliedby$) Assume that for every set C , $A \cap C \subseteq B \cap C$ holds. We need to show $A \subseteq B$.

Let x be an arbitrary element such that $x \in A$.

Since the given hypothesis holds true for any choice of set C , we can choose C to be the singleton set containing only x , that is, $C = \{x\}$.

Now evaluate the intersection $A \cap \{x\}$: since $x \in A$ and $x \in \{x\}$, we have:

$$x \in A \cap \{x\}$$

By our hypothesis, $A \cap \{x\} \subseteq B \cap \{x\}$, which implies:

$$x \in B \cap \{x\}$$

By definition of intersection, this means $x \in B$ and $x \in \{x\}$. In particular, we obtain:

$$x \in B$$

Since $x \in A \implies x \in B$ for any arbitrary element, we conclude by definition of subset that $A \subseteq B$.
The proof is complete.

• **Exercise 9**

Let U be a universal set, and let $A, B \subseteq U$. Prove or disprove: $(A \cup B)^c = A^c \cup B^c$. If the statement is false, give a counterexample.

◦ **Solution 9.1**

The statement is **false**.

Counterexample:

Let the universal set be $U = \{1, 2\}$, and let $A = \{1\}$ and $B = \{2\}$.

First, find the union of A and B :

$$A \cup B = \{1, 2\}$$

By definition of complement, the left-hand side is:

$$(A \cup B)^c = U \setminus \{1, 2\} = \emptyset$$

Now, calculate the complements of A and B separately:

$$A^c = \{2\}, \quad B^c = \{1\}$$

Thus, the right-hand side is:

$$A^c \cup B^c = \{1, 2\}$$

Since $\emptyset \neq \{1, 2\}$, the statement does not hold.

• **Exercise 10**

Suppose $A \subseteq B \cup C$. Does it follow that $A \subseteq B$ or $A \subseteq C$? If not, construct a concrete counterexample.

◦ **Solution 10.1**

No, it **does not follow**.

Counterexample:

Let $A = \{1, 2\}$, $B = \{1\}$, and $C = \{2\}$.

First, evaluate the union of B and C :

$$B \cup C = \{1, 2\}$$

Since every element of A is in $B \cup C$, the condition $A \subseteq B \cup C$ is satisfied.

However, $A \not\subseteq B$ because $2 \in A$ but $2 \notin B$.

Similarly, $A \not\subseteq C$ because $1 \in A$ but $1 \notin C$.

Therefore, the implication is false.

• **Exercise 11**

Let $A, B, C \subseteq X$. Prove: $(A \setminus B) \setminus C = A \setminus (B \cup C)$.

◦ **Solution 11.1**

Proof:

We show that an element x belongs to the left-hand side if and only if it belongs to the right-hand side using basic definition of set-membership:

$$\begin{aligned} x \in (A \setminus B) \setminus C &\iff x \in (A \setminus B) \wedge x \notin C \\ &\iff (x \in A \wedge x \notin B) \wedge x \notin C \\ &\iff x \in A \wedge (x \notin B \wedge x \notin C) \\ &\iff x \in A \wedge \neg(x \in B \vee x \in C) \\ &\iff x \in A \wedge x \notin (B \cup C) \\ &\iff x \in A \setminus (B \cup C) \end{aligned}$$

Since $x \in (A \setminus B) \setminus C \iff x \in A \setminus (B \cup C)$ is logically equivalent, the two sets are equal.

• **Exercise 12**

Let $A, B, C \subseteq X$. Show that $A \cap (B \Delta C) = (A \cap B) \Delta (A \cap C)$, where Δ denotes symmetric difference: $X \Delta Y = (X \setminus Y) \cup (Y \setminus X)$.

◦ **Solution 12.1**

Proof:

By definition of symmetric difference, $B \Delta C = (B \setminus C) \cup (C \setminus B)$. We unpack the condition $x \in A \cap (B \Delta C)$ step by step:

$$\begin{aligned} x \in A \cap (B \Delta C) &\iff x \in A \wedge x \in (B \Delta C) \\ &\iff x \in A \wedge (x \in B \setminus C \vee x \in C \setminus B) \\ &\iff x \in A \wedge ((x \in B \wedge x \notin C) \vee (x \in C \wedge x \notin B)) \\ &\iff (x \in A \wedge x \in B \wedge x \notin C) \vee (x \in A \wedge x \in C \wedge x \notin B) \end{aligned}$$

Now, we unpack the right-hand side expression, $x \in (A \cap B) \Delta (A \cap C)$:

$$\begin{aligned} x \in (A \cap B) \Delta (A \cap C) &\iff x \in ((A \cap B) \setminus (A \cap C)) \vee x \in ((A \cap C) \setminus (A \cap B)) \\ &\iff (x \in A \cap B \wedge x \notin A \cap C) \vee (x \in A \cap C \wedge x \notin A \cap B) \\ &\iff ((x \in A \wedge x \in B) \wedge \neg(x \in A \wedge x \in C)) \vee ((x \in A \wedge x \in C) \wedge \neg(x \in A \wedge x \in B)) \\ &\iff ((x \in A \wedge x \in B) \wedge (x \notin A \vee x \notin C)) \vee ((x \in A \wedge x \in C) \wedge (x \notin A \vee x \notin B)) \end{aligned}$$

In the first component, since $x \in A$ is true, the statement $(x \notin A \vee x \notin C)$ simplifies directly to $x \notin C$.

In the second component, since $x \in A$ is true, the statement $(x \notin A \vee x \notin B)$ simplifies directly to $x \notin B$.

Substituting these simplifications back, we get:

$$(x \in A \wedge x \in B \wedge x \notin C) \vee (x \in A \wedge x \in C \wedge x \notin B)$$

Since both sides reduce to the exact same logical statement, $A \cap (B \Delta C) = (A \cap B) \Delta (A \cap C)$ is proven.

• **Exercise 13**

Another Morgan's Law (Indexed Families): Let $\{A_i\}_{i \in I}$ be a family of sets. Prove:

$$\left(\bigcap_{i \in I} A_i \right)^c = \bigcup_{i \in I} A_i^c$$

◦ **Solution 13.1**

Proof:

We apply the logical definitions of indexed intersection, union, and complement to show element-hood equivalence:

$$\begin{aligned} x \in \left(\bigcap_{i \in I} A_i \right)^c &\iff x \notin \bigcap_{i \in I} A_i \\ &\iff \neg(\forall i \in I, x \in A_i) \\ &\iff \exists i \in I, \neg(x \in A_i) \\ &\iff \exists i \in I, x \notin A_i \\ &\iff \exists i \in I, x \in A_i^c \\ &\iff x \in \bigcup_{i \in I} A_i^c \end{aligned}$$

Since the logical statements match at every point, the set identity holds true.